,headsets, wireless keyboards, wireless mice, printers, bar code scanners and game consoles.

LAN (Local Area Network)

- A **Local Area Network** is a privately owned computer **network** covering a **small Network geographical area**, like a home, office, or groups of buildings e.g. a school Network.
- We can use different types of topologies through LAN.
- LAN networks are also widely used to share resources like printers, shared hard-drive etc.
- The size of LAN is usually small. The various devices in LAN are connected to central devices called **Hub** or **Switch** using a cable.
- Now-a-days LANs are being installed using wireless technologies.
- LAN offers high speed communication of data rates between 4 to 16 megabits per second (Mbps).

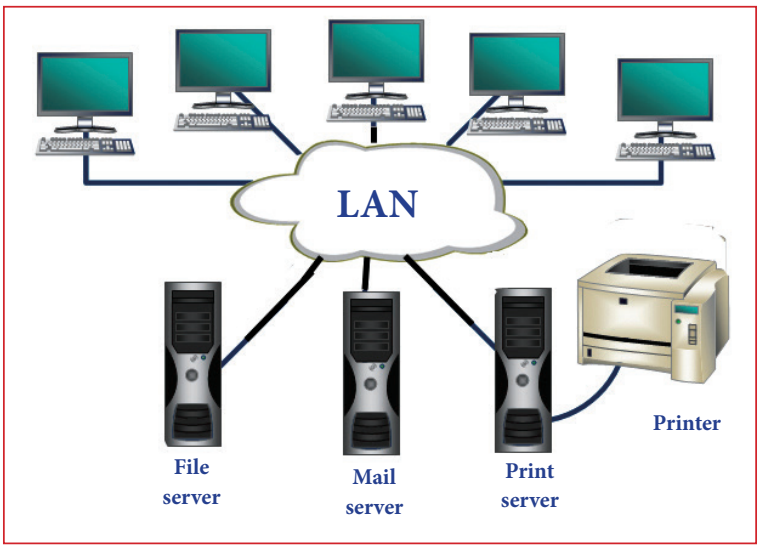


Figure 14.5 Local Area Network

Advantages of LAN

- In this network one can become a server serving all the remaining computers called **clients**. A Software can be stored on the server and it can be used by the remaining clients.
- Without internet access, it is possible to connect all the workstations in a building with each other locally.
- It is easy to share common resources like printers with LAN.

Metropolitan Area Network (MAN)

It is basically a bigger version of LAN. It is designed to extend over the entire city. MANs extend beyond 100 KM. MANs are usually owned by large organizations to interconnect its various branches across a city. MAN comprises combination of different hardware and transmission media. It can be single network such as a cable TV network, or it is a means of connecting a number of LANs into a larger network so that resources can be shared through LAN to LAN as well as device to device.